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ANNEX 2

RESOLUTION MSC.133(76)
(adopted on 12 December 2002)

ADOPTION OF TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FOR MEANS OF
ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONS

THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,

RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee,

NOTING the new regulation II-1/3-6 of the In ternational Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), 1974, as amended (hereinaft er referred to as "the Convention") adopted by resolution MSC.134(76), concerning access to and with in spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers,

NOTING ALSO that the aforementioned regulation provides that the means of access referred to therein shall comply with the requirements of Technical provisions for means of access for inspections (hereinafter referred to as "the Technical provisions") to be made mandatory under the Convention;

RECOGNIZING that the Technical provisions referred to above are not intended to

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SOURCE: MSC.133(76).pdf
access for inspections (hereinafter referred to as "the Technical provisions") to be made mandatory under the Convention;

RECOGNIZING that the Technical provisions referred to above are not intended to inhibit the development of new or novel technol ogies which provide for an improved means to carry out ship surveys and inspections,

HAVING CONSIDERED, at its seventy-sixth session, the text of the proposed Technical provisions,

1. ADOPTS the Technical provisions for means of access for inspections, the text of which is set out in the Annex to the present resolution;

2. INVITES Contracting Governments to th e Convention to note that the Technical provisions will take effect on 1 January 2005 upon en try into force of the new regulation II-1/3-6 of the Convention;

3. REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit certified copies of this resolution and the text of the Technical provisions contained in th e Annex to all Contracting Governments to the Convention;

4. FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and

the Annex to all Members of the Organization, which are not Contracting Governments to the Convention;

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Convention;

4. FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and the Annex to all Members of the Organization, which are not Contracting Governments to the Convention;

5. INVITES Governments to encourage the de velopment of novel technologies aimed at facilitating the survey and inspection of ships and to keep the Organization advised of any positive results.
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TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FOR MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONS

Preamble

It has long been recognised that the only way of ensuring that the condition of a ship's structure is maintained to conform with the applicable requirements is for all its components to be surveyed on a regular basis throughout their operationa l life so as to ensure that they are free from damage such as cracks, buckling or defo rmation due to corrosion, overloading or contact damage and that thickness diminution is within established limits. The provision of suitable

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from damage such as cracks, buckling or defo rmation due to corrosion, overloading or contact damage and that thickness diminution is within established limits. The provision of suitable means of access to the hull structure for the pur pose of carrying out overall and close-up surveys and inspections is essential and such means shoul d be considered and provided for at the ship design stage.

Ships should be designed and built with due consid eration as to how they will be surveyed by flag State inspectors and classification society surveyors during their in-service life and how the crew will be able to monitor the condition of th e ship. Without adequate access, the structural condition of the ship can deteriorate undetected and major structural failure can arise. A comprehensive approach to design and maintenan ce is required to cover the whole projected life of the ship.

In order to address this issue, the Organiza tion has developed these Technical provisions for means of access for inspections, intended to facilitate close-up inspections and thickness measurements of the ship's structure referred to in SOLAS regulation II-1/3-6 on Access to and

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means of access for inspections, intended to facilitate close-up inspections and thickness measurements of the ship’s structure referred to in SOLAS regulation II-1/3-6 on Access to and within spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers.

Definitions

Terms used in the Technical provisions have the same meaning as those defined in the 1974 SOLAS Convention, as amended, and in resolution A.744(18), as amended.

Technical provisions

1 Structural members subject to the close-up inspections and thickness measurements of the ship’s structure referred to in SOLAS regula tion II-1/3-6, except those in double bottom spaces, shall be provided with a permanent means of acce ss to the extent as specified in table 1 and table 2, as applicable. For oil tankers and wing ba llast tanks of ore carriers, rafting may be used in addition to the specified permanent means of access, provided that the structure allows for its safe and effective use.

2 Elevated passageways, where fitted, sha ll have a minimum width of 600 mm and be provided with toe boards not less than 150 mm high and guard rails over both sides of their entire

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safe and effective use.

2 Elevated passageways, where fitted, sha ll have a minimum width of 600 mm and be provided with toe boards not less than 150 mm high and guard rails over both sides of their entire length. Sloping structure providing part of the access shall be of a non-skid construction. Guard rails shall be 1,000 mm in height and consist of a rail and intermediate bar 500 mm in height and of substantial construction. Stanchions shall be not more than 3 m apart.

3 Access to elevated passageways and vertical openings from the ship’s bottom shall be provided by means of easily accessible passageways, la dders or treads. Treads shall be provided with lateral support for the foot. Where the rungs of ladders are fitted against a vertical surface, the distance from the centre of the rungs to the surface shall be at least 150 mm. Where vertical manholes are fitted higher than 600 mm above the walking level, access shall be facilitated by means of treads and hand grips with platform landings on both sides.
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means of treads and hand grips with platform landings on both sides.
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4 Tunnels passing through cargo holds shall be e quipped with ladders or steps at each end of the hold so that personnel may easily cross such tunnels.

5 Permanent ladders, except for vertical ladders, which are fitted on vertical structures for close-up inspection or thickness measurement, shall be inclined at an angle of less than 70. There shall be no obstructions within 750 mm of th e face of the inclined ladder, except that in way of an opening this clearance may be reduced to 600 mm. The flights of ladders shall not be more than 9 m in actual length. Resting platform s of adequate dimensions shall be provided. Ladders and handrails shall be constructed of steel or equivalent material of adequate strength and stiffness and securely attached to the ta nk structure by stays. The method of support and length of stay shall be such that vibration is reduced to a practical minimum. In cargo holds,

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and stiffness and securely attached to the ta nk structure by stays. The method of support and